

CUNY Beyond - Implemented Features

Purpose

CUNY Beyond is a public, career-first pre-advisement module inside the Academic Advisement System. It helps prospective, returning, working, transfer, and current students prepare for a human advising conversation. It does not replace an advisor or official degree audit.

Conversational onboarding

- Chatbot-style window with assistant and user message bubbles.
- Five-question conversation covering student pathway, career goal, employment, skills, and possible prior learning.
- Optional quick-choice tags for structured answers.
- Free-text career entry and a searchable reviewed-career browser.
- Back and Start over controls.
- Keyboard-operable choices, visible focus, status announcements, and responsive layout.
- Anonymous browser draft with expiration; no account required.

Reviewed career matching

- 46 reviewed career profiles and 50 reviewed career-program relationships.
- Common job-title aliases such as bookkeeper, case worker, law enforcement, and city planner.
- Up to three ranked BMCC starting points.
- Transparent career and selected-skill score components.
- Evidence labels and plain-language explanations.
- Official source, review date, department, degree, and catalog information.
- Clear warnings where transfer, certification, licensure, or graduate education may be required.
- Safe no-match behavior that never fabricates a recommendation.

Supported program families

Coverage includes Computer Science, Data Science, Nursing, Accounting, Human Services, Psychology General and STEM, Criminal Justice, Public and Nonprofit Administration, Urban Studies, Political Science, and Gerontology. Only populated program curricula are eligible for recommendations.

Prior-learning preparation

- Screens for previous college credit, standardized exams, ACE/NCCRS learning, employer training, military learning, licenses, language proficiency, portfolios, and experience.
- Labels results as possible opportunities requiring official evaluation.
- Produces a document checklist and official next steps.
- Does not estimate, promise, or apply credit.

Degree-map handoff

- Opens a recommendation in the existing interactive degree planner.
- Carries institution, program, catalog year, and source context through browser session storage.
- Connects to completed-course selection, prerequisites, alternatives, electives, progress, planning, and PDF export.

Transfer and schedule support

- Displays reviewed transfer options when available.
- Preserves explicit warnings when no reviewed destination is published.
- Provides verified term and course filters for CUNY Global Search.
- Keeps registration in CUNYfirst.
- Live sections remain disabled unless an official provider is documented, approved, and implemented.

Advising summary and referral

- Builds a concise browser-local pre-advisement package.
- Includes pathway, career goal, skills, recommendations, CPL possibilities, transfer options, and schedule checklist.
- Offers a downloadable summary.
- Requests name, email, optional last-four ID digits, and consent only at the referral step.
- Provides manual copy/download fallback if electronic delivery is unavailable.

Administration and governance

- Protected governance dashboard for careers, skills, program mappings, CPL guidance, transfer options, and sources.
- Draft, review, approve, publish, archive, version, rollback, and source-validation concepts.
- Review dates and explanations are stored with mappings.
- Public endpoints expose published records, not drafts.
- Schedule-provider governance fails closed.

Privacy and limitations

- No login required for public exploration.
- Visitors are told not to enter private data during onboarding.
- Short-lived local browser storage is used for drafts and handoffs.
- Results do not guarantee admission, graduation, employment, salary, transfer credit, CPL credit, licensure, course eligibility, or seat availability.
- DegreeWorks, official college sources, advisors, evaluators, Global Search, and CUNYfirst remain authoritative.